

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Review rights, CoE issues, and reapplying with a stronger case

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	The case officer wasn't satisfied you met the requirements - most commonly, financial evidence, a CoE mismatch, or the Genuine Student requirement.	Whether independent merits review is available depends on your specific circumstances - check your refusal letter carefully.
Reapplication	A new application, assessed fresh, generally with an updated or reissued CoE if enough time has passed.	The most common path - confirm with your provider whether your existing CoE can be reused or needs reissuing first.

If your CoE is involved

If the refusal cites a CoE mismatch or your intended start date has passed, contact your provider's international office promptly - they may be able to reissue your CoE for a later intake, but this takes time to arrange.

If financial evidence was the issue

- Recheck the exact formula in the Financial Requirements Overview - a shortfall is often a specific, fixable calculation error rather than a general lack of funds
- Confirm your evidence showed a genuine, ongoing pattern rather than a single recent deposit
- If you're bringing family members, confirm you included their additional living-cost amounts too

If the Genuine Student requirement was the issue

Read the refusal reasons for the specific concern raised. A reapplication should directly and specifically address that concern, with a clearer, more specific statement - see the Genuine Student Statement Templates (Complete tier).

What not to do

- Don't reapply with the same CoE and evidence unchanged
- Don't omit a previous refusal or visa cancellation on a later application

- Don't submit a CoE or documents you know to be inaccurate to work around a previous refusal

When to seek professional advice

Consider consulting a Registered Migration Agent (RMA) if you've been refused multiple times, if your case involves complex academic history, or if you're unsure what review rights (if any) apply to your specific refusal.